

Furthermore, Franck's earliest compositions met with little acclaim. His initial work, a set of trios for piano, violin, and cello (Op. 1), was published after winning the support of Chopin and Liszt, but his first large-scale composition, a biblical oratorio on Ruth, was greeted unenthusiastically at its premiere in January 1846.

Family tensions increased further when he fell in love with Félicité Saillot Desmousseaux, the daughter of two actors. His father opposed the match, but the couple married during the Paris riots of 1848. Guests clambered over barricades to reach the church: an omen, perhaps, of a marriage that was to have its stormy moments. But, finally freed from the tyrannical interference of his father, Franck pursued a fresh course—the organ, rather than the piano, became his principal instrument, as he sought the security of a church organist's post.